

**SOURCES SOUGHT NOTICE
AND REQUEST FOR INFORMATION
MISSION TRAINING COMPLEX CAPABILITIES SUPPORT (MTCCS) III**

INTRODUCTION:

The U.S. Army Contracting Command - Orlando (ACC-Orlando) is issuing this Sources Sought Notice (SSN) for the Mission Training Complex Capabilities Support III (MTCCS III) program for the purposes of conducting market research to identify potential sources having an interest in and resources to successfully perform the requirement of the MTCCS III effort. The effort includes services and support for individual through collective Mission Command (MC) training; Leadership Training/Development; the Military Decision-Making Process (MDMP); Warfighter Functions (WFF) training; First Person Simulations (Gaming); and constructive simulations supported training, including planning, preparation, set-up, execution and recovery, as well as facilities management, event scheduling, security and administrative support, and access control. These training events may occur concurrently or separately at multiple hub and spoke Mission Training Complex (MTC) locations throughout CONUS and OCONUS locations. The Contractor shall be capable of combining events into a simultaneous synthetic environment using the simulations and Mission Command Information Systems (MCiS) fielded to MTC. These services support U.S. Army Title 10 training, deployment training events, and Mission Rehearsal Exercises (MRE). These services may also support Joint, Combined, NATO, and service component commanders, staff and leader constructive simulation training and assistance in executing the Combatant Commanders' engagement strategy.

The result of this market research will contribute to determining the method of procurement, if a requirement materializes. Based on the responses to this sources sought notice, this requirement may be set-aside for small businesses (in full or in part) or procured through full and open competition. Multiple awards may be made. All small business set-aside categories will be considered. Telephone inquiries will not be accepted or acknowledged, and no feedback or evaluations will be provided to companies regarding submissions.

DISCLAIMER:

THIS SOURCES SOUGHT IS FOR INFORMATIONAL PURPOSES ONLY. THIS IS NOT A REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL (RFP) TO BE SUBMITTED. IT DOES NOT CONSTITUTE A SOLICITATION AND SHALL NOT BE CONSTRUED AS A COMMITMENT BY THE GOVERNMENT. RESPONSES IN ANY FORM ARE NOT OFFERS AND THE GOVERNMENT IS UNDER NO OBLIGATION TO AWARD A CONTRACT AS A RESULT OF THIS ANNOUNCEMENT. NO FUNDS ARE AVAILABLE TO PAY FOR PREPARATION OF RESPONSES TO THIS ANNOUNCEMENT. ANY INFORMATION SUBMITTED BY RESPONDENTS TO THIS TECHNICAL DESCRIPTION IS STRICTLY VOLUNTARY. RESPONSES WILL NOT BE RETURNED TO RESPONDENTS. NOT RESPONDING TO THIS NOTICE DOES NOT PRECLUDE PARTICIPATION IN ANY FUTURE SOLICITATION, IF ISSUED. IF A SOLICITATION IS RELEASED, IT WILL BE SYNOPSISIZED ON THE GOVERNMENT-WIDE POINT OF ENTRY (GPE). IT IS THE

RESPONSIBILITY OF POTENTIAL OFFERORS TO MONITOR THE GPE FOR ADDITIONAL INFORMATION PERTAINING TO THIS REQUIREMENT.”

BASED ON THE RESPONSES TO THIS SOURCES SOUGHT NOTICE, THIS REQUIREMENT MAY BE SET-ASIDE FOR SMALL BUSINESSES (IN FULL OR IN PART) OR PROCURED THROUGH FULL AND OPEN COMPETITION, AND MULTIPLE AWARDS MAY BE MADE. ALL SMALL BUSINESS SET-ASIDE CATEGORIES WILL BE CONSIDERED. TELEPHONE INQUIRIES WILL NOT BE ACCEPTED OR ACKNOWLEDGED, AND NO FEEDBACK OR EVALUATIONS WILL BE PROVIDED TO COMPANIES REGARDING THEIR SUBMISSIONS.

PROGRAM BACKGROUND:

The Department of the Army (DA) G 3/5/7 has designated the Mission Training Complex (MTC) as the vehicle for providing collective training and sustainment on Army MCiS, the Command-and-Control Warfighting Function (WfF), and the Army’s approach to MC using a variety of tools and Army fielded systems. The doctrine outlining the MTC mission is found in the Army’s Training Circular (TC) 6 series. MTC’s supports small unit (Squad through Company), Medium units (Battalion through Brigade), and large units (Echelons above BDE) in training environments replicating Multidomain Operations. The Army fields digital MCiS to units from platoon through theater level. MTC’s focus on realistic and demanding training. MC focuses our support on a unit’s organizational leadership and supporting staff. MC doctrine requires Commanders and their staffs to issue intent-based orders, which empowers units at every echelon with the freedom to improve and adapt in a complex Operating Environment (OE). Organizational leaders and their staffs must conduct realistic and relevant training, which builds trust within formations that translates to mission accomplishment on the battlefield. Live, Virtual, Constructive, and Gaming (LVC-G) legacy and future models and simulations are required to create realistic and challenging training events that closely replicate conditions a unit would face on the battlefield.

REQUIRED CAPABILITIES:

Support individual through collective MC training, WfF training, the MDMP, Games for Training (GFT), the Joint Operational Planning Process (JOPP), NATO Operational - Level Planning Process, mission rehearsal, and constructive simulations exercises. Constructive simulation training exercises include planning, preparation, set-up, execution, and recovery. These training events and exercises may occur concurrently or separately. Assist the Government in providing constructive simulation, GFT resources, and adaptive and responsive training for the individual through echelons above Brigade (EAB). Be capable of combining events into a simultaneous synthetic environment using the simulations and MCiS fielded to MTC. These services support U.S. Army Title 10 training, deployment training events, and Mission Rehearsal Exercises (MRE). These services may also support Joint, Combined, NATO, and service component commander, staff and leader constructive simulation training and assistance in executing the Combatant Commanders’ engagement strategy. Further detail is provided in the draft Performance Work Statement (PWS) attached to this announcement (Attachment 1).

SPECIAL REQUIREMENTS:

- **Personnel and Facility Security Clearances.** This MATOC requires Secret clearances and in some cases Top Secret (TS) clearances with access to Sensitive Compartmented Information (SCI). All Contractor personnel performing work under a Task Order (TO) shall have at the minimum, an Interim Secret clearance with US ACCESS at start of full performance and shall maintain the level of security required for the life of the TO. A Contractor employee's failure to maintain a valid security clearance shall result in the Contractor employee not being allowed to perform duties contained in a TO. Such failure of an employee does not relieve the Contractor from timely performance of the TO requirements. All Contractor personnel requiring privileged accounts on classified Government Information Systems and/or networks require a Single Scope Background Investigation (SSBI) or Tier 5 investigation, to include a current SSBI Periodic Reinvestigation (SSBI-PR), or Tier 5 Reinvestigation (Tier 5R) if applicable, even if the individual does not require access to information classified as TOP SECRET.
- **Sensitive Compartmented Information Facility (SCIF).** The Contractor shall provide operational support and management for SCIF at selected MTC locations as directed by the Government in subordinate TO.
- **Network Enclave Management.** The Contractor shall provide network enclaves, information system infrastructure, and telecommunications services at the MTC and other sites in support of exercises and training events, as the Government directs. The Contractor shall engineer, operate, maintain, protect, and defend MTC network infrastructure and telecommunication devices (e.g., VoIP call manager).
- **Constructive Simulation Support.** The Contractor shall operate Government provided simulations (e.g., Next Generation Constructive (NGC), Joint Land Component Constructive Training Capability (JLCCTC), and Joint Live Virtual/Constructive (JLVC)). The Contractor shall operate and maintain any future and emerging simulations technologies fielded by the Government. The Contractor shall provide constructive simulations planning, set up, configuration, testing, execution, and recovery support.
- **Intelligence Simulation Planning, Configuration, and Execution.** The Contractor shall provide intelligence simulations planning, configuration, testing and execution support for the Intelligence Electronic Warfare Tactical Proficiency Trainer (IEWTPT), Intelligence Low Overhead Driver (ILOD), Warfighter's Simulation (WARSIM) Intelligence Module (WIM), Air and Space Collaborative Environment – Information Operations Suite (ACE-IOS), and other Intelligence simulation systems as directed by the Government.
- **Applicability and Implications of the Clinger-Cohen Act.** This effort involves Information Technology (IT) services. These services are identified as providing exercise

communication and support and maintaining and updating. The Army MTCCS III services may acquire Commercial Off-The-Shelf (COTS) products, and when it does so will utilize the U.S. Army Computer Hardware Enterprise Software and Solutions (CHESS) program in accordance with the terms and conditions of the contract and Title 40 Clinger Cohen Act (CCA).

ACQUISITION STRATEGY - PLANNING INFORMATION:

1. **Contract Vehicle:** The determination of Contract Vehicle and Small Business Set Aside or Full and Open Competition will not be established until market research has been completed and the Acquisition Strategy has been approved.
2. **North American Industry Classification System (NAICS):** The applicable NAICS code for this requirement is 541990 (All Other Professional, Scientific, and Technical Services), with a Small Business Size Standard of \$19.5M. The applicable Product Service Code (PSC) is R425 (Support Professional: Engineering/Tech). Business of all sizes are encouraged to respond; however, each respondent must clearly identify their business size in their capabilities statement.
 - *NOTE 01: The current SBA Table of Small Business Size Standards was updated 17 March 2023; since the beginning of 2022, the SBA has regularly updated the table to account for inflation. Businesses must update their SAM.gov profiles in order to have their small business status reflect the most current small business size standards. Until updated, the SAM profiles will continue to display the small business status under outdated size standards.*
 - *NOTE 02: In accordance with 13 C.F.R. 121.104, the current calculation for dollar (monetary) value based NAICS codes is average total receipts over the last five (5) completed fiscal years.*
 - *NOTE 03: In accordance with 13 C.F.R. 121.106, the current calculation for employee based NAICS codes is average number of employees used for each pay period for the preceding completed 24 calendar months.*
3. **Contract Type:** The determination of Contract Type will not be established until market research has been completed and the Acquisition Strategy has been approved.
4. **Anticipated Period of Performance (PoP):** The anticipated PoP is expected to be a minimum of five (5) years with performance commencing in December 2028. Specifics regarding option years, if any, will be provided in the Solicitation. The Level of Effort (LOE) for five years is estimated at 1,583 man-year equivalents.
5. **Place of Performance:** Multiple locations throughout CONUS and OCONUS. Specific locations will be identified at Task Order Level.

6. **Industry Feedback:** The Government seeks input from industry regarding recommended acquisition strategy, contract structure, and best practices to support the successful execution of this requirement. Respondents are encouraged to provide feedback, recommendations, lessons learned, and any additional insights that may inform acquisition planning and improve outcomes. All information will be considered for planning purposes only and does not obligate the Government to pursue any particular approach. The Government is particularly interested in answers to the questions included in the Request for Information below.
7. **Industry Day/Site Visit:** The Government anticipates conducting an Industry Day and/or Site Visit in support of this requirement at a later date. Details regarding the date, time, location, and participation procedures will be provided in a separate notice when the event is scheduled. The purpose of this event will be to provide interested vendors with additional information regarding the requirement, provide an opportunity to tour certain areas of specific interest to the Government, and to facilitate further engagement with industry. Attendance at the event is not a requirement and in no way will it have any effect on any company from submitting a response to this Sources Sought Notice and/or a proposal in response to any forthcoming solicitation. Interested vendors are encouraged to monitor SAM.gov for updates and future notices related to this requirement.

SUBMISSION DETAILS:

Interested businesses shall submit a capability statement (10 pages maximum) demonstrating their ability to fulfill the functions and tasks described herein and within Attachment 1. The statement shall include/address the following:

1. Organization name, address, email address, web site address, telephone number, business size, and type of ownership for the organization. **A primary and alternate Point of Contact (POC) with email and phone number.**
2. A statement indicating if your firm is a large or small business under NAICS code 541990 (All Other Professional, Scientific and Technical Services); if small business, please indicate any applicable socio-economic status [i.e., 8a, Small Disadvantaged Business (SDB), HUBZone, Veteran-Owned Small Business (VOSB), Service-Disabled Veteran-Owned Small Business (SDVOSB), or Women-Owned Small Business (WOSB)].
3. **Are you interested in being a prime contractor or only a subcontractor? If only interested in being a subcontractor, please identify what percentage of the work you could perform along with the specific task areas. If you are interested in being a prime contractor, please identify the percentage of work you plan to self-perform and list any potential teaming partners/subcontractors by name and UEI and if large or small and what percentage of work is estimated to be subcontracted out to each partner.**
4. If you plan on subcontracting to other companies in order to deliver technical capability, please provide details on exactly which tasks will be assigned to those subcontractors; in

addition, provide the names of those anticipated subcontractors, and list the anticipated percentage of small business subcontracting.

5. What type of work has your company performed in the past in support of the same or similar requirement? **Please list any relevant contract numbers, total contract value, PoP, brief description of services provided, and indicate if there is a CPARS available.**
6. Can or has your company managed a task of this nature? **If so, do you provide these tasks/services commercially?** Please provide details.
7. What specific technical skills does your company possess which ensure capability to perform the tasks?
8. Please note that under a Small-Business Set-Aside, in accordance with FAR 52.219-14, the small business prime must perform at least 50% of the work themselves in terms of the cost of performance. Provide an explanation of your company's ability to perform at least 50% of the tasking described in the PWS throughout the duration of the contract.
9. Provide a statement including current small/large business status and company profile to include number of employees, annual revenue history, office locations, Unique Entity ID (UEI) number, etc.
10. Describe the organizations ability to meet the requirements in the Facility and Safeguarding requirements.

The Government will assess market information to ascertain potential market capacity to: 1) provide services consistent, in scope and scale, with those described in this notice and otherwise anticipated; 2) secure and apply the full range of corporate financial, human capital, and technical resources required to successfully perform similar requirements; 3) implement a successful project management plan that includes: compliance with tight program schedules; cost containment; meeting and tracking performance; hiring and retention of key personnel and risk mitigation; and 4) provide services under a performance based service acquisition contract.

Your response to this Sources Sought Notice shall be electronically submitted to the Contract Specialist via email, willie.c.bass2.civ@army.mil and copy (Cc) usarmy.redstone.acc.mbx.mtccs-contracting-team@army.mil no later than the response date and time indicated above. The Subject Line of the email shall contain the following: **ATTN: Mr. Will Bass, SAM.gov Notice Number and Title, and Vendor Name.** Reference the SAM.gov Notice Number and Title on all enclosed documents. Responses shall either use Microsoft Office 365 compatible (.xlsx, .docx or .pptx) or Adobe Acrobat 9 Pro (.pdf) formats. Responses shall be in sufficient detail for the Government to determine that your business possesses the necessary functional area expertise and experience to compete for this acquisition. Information and materials submitted in response to this request WILL NOT be returned. All information/materials received in response to this Sources Sought Notice that is marked or

designated as corporate or proprietary will be fully protected from any release outside the Government. DO NOT SUBMIT CLASSIFIED MATERIAL.

***NOTE (LIMITATIONS ON SUBCONTRACTING):** *If you are a small business interested in being the prime contractor for this effort, please be advised that FAR clause 52.219-14 (Limitations on Subcontracting) (DEVIATION 2021-O0008 **Rev 1**) was updated on **15 February 2023**. The current clause adds the definition of “Similarly Situated Entity” and the 50% calculation for compliance with the clause. Small business prime contractors may now count “first tier subcontractor” work performed by a “Similarly Situated Entity” as if it were performed by the prime contractor itself.*

To assist in our market research and set-aside determination for this effort, if you are a small business interested in priming this effort and plan to utilize a “Similarly Situated Entity” to meet the Limitations on Subcontracting requirements, please identify the name & Unique Entity ID/CAGE Code of the specific firm(s) you intend to partner/subcontract with to meet the requirements as well as their SB size status under the NAICS that you as the prime would assign for their workshare. Information regarding any planned “Similarly Situated Entity” should be included in answering any questions outlined in the SSN in order to assist the Government's capability determination.

REQUEST FOR INFORMATION QUESTIONS

Input is requested on the following concepts. Answers to these questions are separate from the information requested in the described capability statement. There is no page limit on your responses to these questions.

- 1) Consistent with our current approach to acquiring services for the MTCs, the Government is considering a new multiple award task order contract. However, evaluating proposals for the many orders is time consuming and labor intensive. What acquisition strategy / suggestions do you recommend to speed the process of task order evaluation / award?
- 2) We are considering alternatives that will allow for lowest priced, technically acceptable (LPTA) task order awards. Are there any alternative strategies you would recommend?
- 3) If the Government was to use LPTA, we are concerned about disruption to the workforce related to reduction of pay for existing employees at each location. What techniques do you recommend to prevent such issues from arising?
- 4) Are you aware of any existing indefinite delivery / indefinite quantity vehicles or other contract vehicles that include scope for the described services?
- 5) Do you have an opinion on whether commercial services could be used to fulfill these requirements? If you believe commercial services provide a viable alternative, please explain and identify suggested commercial service contract vehicles.
- 6) Any suggestion on a different NAICS with rationale.
- 7) Our most recent task order competitions for these requirements have used the following technical evaluation criteria:

FACTOR 1 TECHNICAL

SUBFACTOR 1.1 STAFFING PLAN:

Proposal Instructions: Sub-Factor 1.1- Staffing Plan: The Offeror shall provide its Staffing Plan (In Contractor Format) to meet the requirements in accordance with the Attachment 1 - PWS. The Offeror is being provided Attachment 2 - Technical Exhibits which demonstrates the Government's estimated schedule and historical throughput requirements. This attachment shall be used for proposal planning purposes only. The Offeror shall provide detailed rationale to support its staffing plan. The Offeror's rationale shall demonstrate how they will meet or exceed the requirements, and the throughput requirements identified in the Attachment 2 - Technical Exhibit given any proposed deviation from Attachment 2 -Technical Exhibit.

Evaluation Criteria: The Government will evaluate the adequacy, feasibility, and effectiveness of the Offeror's Staffing Plan (labor category, hours per labor category, and

qualifications) to meet or exceed all requirements as described in the Attachment 1 - PWS and Attachment 2 - Technical Exhibit.

SUBFACTOR 1.2 RECRUITMENT AND RETENTION STRATEGY:

Proposal Instructions: Sub-Factor 1.2- Recruitment and Retention Strategy: The Offeror shall identify its Recruitment and Retention Strategy to fill positions and retain personnel.

Evaluation Criteria: The Government will evaluate the Offeror's Recruitment and Retention Strategy to ensure that it mitigates performance risk, is effective, and feasible.

SUBFACTOR 1.3 PHASE-IN-PLAN:

Proposal Instructions: Sub-Factor 1.3- Phase In Plan: The Offeror shall provide a Phase in Plan that provides for an uninterrupted workplace changeover from the incumbent with no loss of service and minimal loss of corporate knowledge. The plan shall address the following elements:

- a) Requirements Turnover/Handoff
- b) Quality Assurance
- c) Data and/or Property Transfer
- d) Security Requirements to include OPSEC

Evaluation Criteria: The Government will evaluate the Offeror's Phase in Plan to assess its adequacy and effectiveness at ensuring an uninterrupted changeover from the incumbent, with no loss of service, and minimal loss of corporate knowledge.

Do you have any suggestions / recommendations related to this evaluation criteria?